

Keepsake handprint

Capture your baby's tiny handprint forever. This project is best done when baby is more than four months old. Before then her hand will close when you touch it, making it difficult to get a clear handprint.

YOU WILL NEED ✿ water-based non-toxic paint in the colour of your choice

✿ paintbrush ✿ watercolour paper ✿ craft knife ✿ ruler ✿ cutting mat ✿ scissors

✿ 33 x 33cm (13 x 13in) patterned fabric, or large enough to fit the frame ✿ masking tape

✿ double-sided tape ✿ 25 x 25cm (10 x 10in) frame, or the size of your choice



1 Apply the paint to your baby's hand using a paintbrush. Gently press her hand on the watercolour paper to make a print. Repeat the process, if necessary, until you have a clear print you are happy with. Wash the paint off your baby's hand and leave the handprint to dry.



2 Using a craft knife, ruler, and cutting mat, trim the watercolour paper so the handprint is centred within a square. Leave approximately 2.5cm (1in) of white space around the print. Make sure the square of paper is smaller than the frame by approximately 5cm (2in) so that the fabric will form a background to the handprint.



3 Cut the fabric to the size of the frame's backing board, adding approximately 2.5cm (1in) extra all round. Wrap the excess fabric around the backing board and stick it to the back with masking tape.

